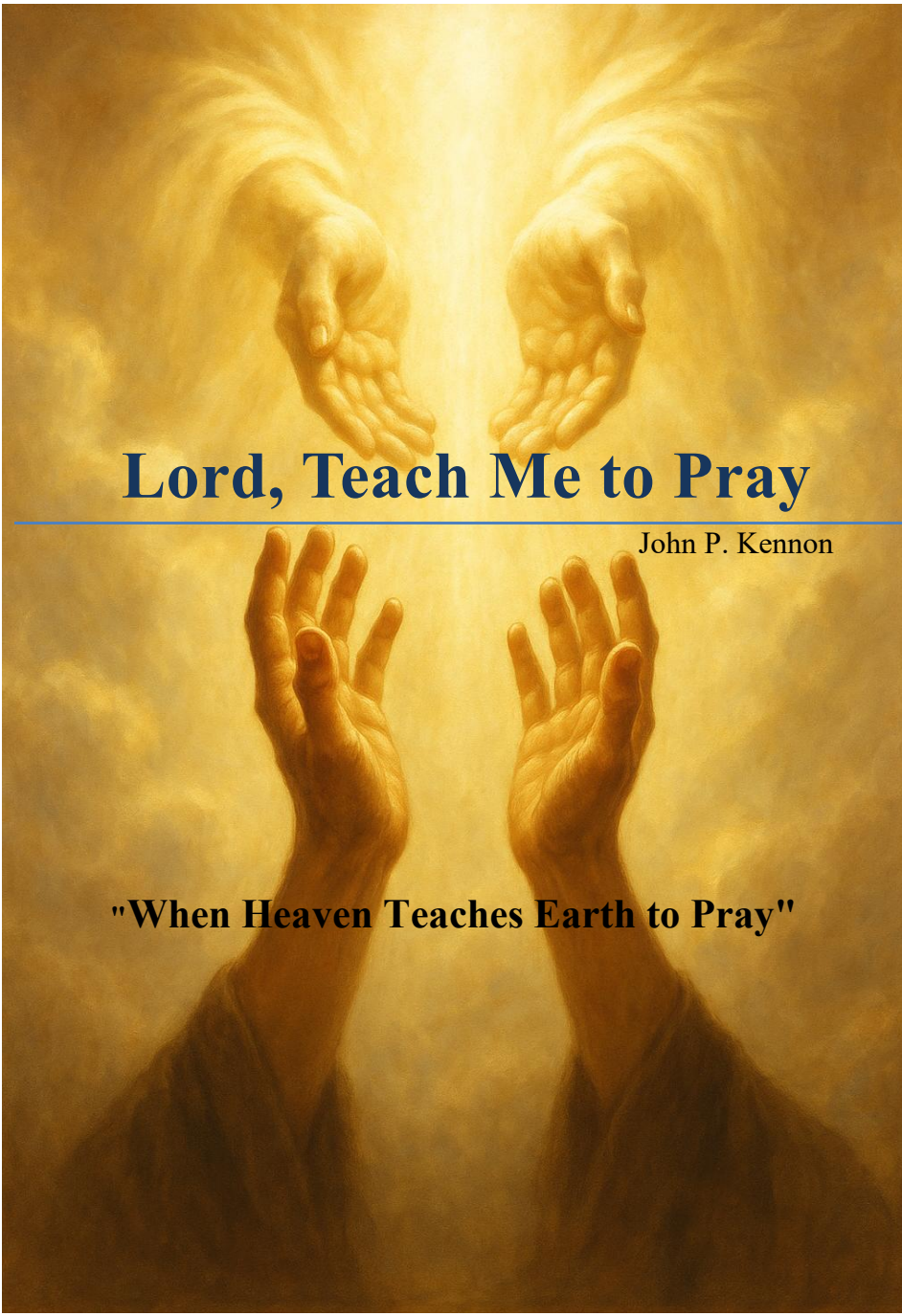


Lord, Teach Me to Pray

John P. Kennon

"When Heaven Teaches Earth to Pray"

Introduction

“Pray that God prays through you—bringing His will from heaven into your life.”

Prayer is more than routine. It's not just a discipline—it’s a dialogue. A relationship. A rhythm. A response to God's voice.

Many believers don’t lack passion—they lack direction. They burn with desire but need practical direction. After nearly 30 years of walking with God, I came to a season where I had no prayers. I had hunger—but the prayer life was sucked out of me. And right there, the Lord met me, in what felt like a lifeless moment. This message was born from that moment. Let what follows stir your spirit, anchor your faith, and draw you into deeper intimacy with God.

Don’t just read—pray. Don’t just listen—respond.

Hebrews 11:1 – “Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.”
Hebrews 11:6 – “Without faith it is impossible to please Him…”

Prayer without faith is just noise. But prayer spoken in faith? That’s where miracles begin.

Prayer Is Labor, but Not in Vain

John 6:27 – “Labour not for the meat which perisheth, but for that meat which endureth unto everlasting life…”

True labor in the Lord is **anchored in prayer**. Yes, it involves trial and error. Some are blessed with mentors. Others are simply pulled deeper by a divine hunger—a God-given ache to know Him more.

I don’t present this as someone who has mastered prayer, but as one still learning, still longing, still listening. A student. A son. A vessel.

The Lord's Prayer: Heaven's Blueprint

To pray *"Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven"* isn't just bold—it's divine alignment. It's not only possible—it's **invited**. But it must be done **God's way**. Jesus didn't give us a script—He gave us a structure. A spiritual framework. A heaven-born blueprint.

Matthew 6:5–15 – The Lord's Prayer is heaven's architecture, forever settled in glory.

Each phrase aligns us with the heart of God:

1. **Relationship** – *Our Father*
2. **Worship** – *Hallowed be Thy Name*
3. **Authority** – *Thy Kingdom Come*
4. **Surrender** – *Thy Will Be Done*
5. **Provision** – *Give us this day…*
6. **Grace** – *Forgive us…*
7. **Mercy** – *As we forgive others…*
8. **Guidance** – *Lead us…*
9. **Deliverance** – *Deliver us from evil…*
10. **Glory** – *For Thine is the Kingdom…*

By Grace Through Faith

Ephesians 2:4–10
We are saved by grace, through faith—not of works, but as God's workmanship, created for good works ordained before time.

Final Invitation
As you walk through these ten chapters, **slow down**. **Linger. Listen.**

Let the Lord's Prayer open up a **river of life**—unceasing, deep, and overflowing with His presence. This is not just a study. It's an encounter. Let heaven pray through you. This is a faithful prayer ever present help in all times in all seasons and for always.

I. Relationship: 'Our Father'

Prayer begins not with performance, but with **relationship**. Jesus opens the Lord's Prayer not with demands, but with identity: **"Our Father…"** – the invitation to approach God not as a distant deity, but as a loving, present, personal Father.

- **Prayer Is...**
  - A **relationship**—not a ritual
  - A **rhythm**—a daily heartbeat of connection
  - A **response**—to God's voice, not just our needs

Matthew 6:5–15 – Jesus anchors the model prayer in relationship: "*Our Father* which art in heaven…"

- **How Do I Relate to God as My Father?**

You are not defined by your past, your shame, or your failures. You are **defined by sonship**—a new identity forged in Christ.

2 Corinthians 5:21 – "He made Him to be sin for us... that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him."
Ephesians 1:4–6 – "He hath made us accepted in the beloved."
Romans 8:37 – "In all these things we are more than conquerors through Him that loved us."

- **Your Identity in Christ:**

  - You are not rejected—you are **accepted**
  - You are not defeated—you are **more than a conqueror**
  - You are not a slave to fear—you are a **child of God**

Declaration: *I am more than a conqueror. I am accepted. I am a child of the King.*

- **God as Father – A Scriptural Portrait**
  - **Romans 8:15** – We cry, "*Abba, Father*" by the Spirit of adoption
  - **1 John 3:1** – "What manner of love the Father has bestowed… we should be called the sons of God"
  - **Matthew 6:9** – "*Our Father* which art in heaven…"
  - **Psalm 103:13** – "Like a father has compassion on his children, so the Lord has compassion…"
  - **2 Corinthians 6:18** – "I will be a Father to you... you shall be my sons and daughters"

The word *Father* implies more than affection—it speaks of provision, instruction, leadership, and protection. He is not just your Creator—He is your **Covenant Keeper.**

- **Faith: The Fuel of Prayer**

This brings us to one of the most vital aspects of prayer: **faith**.
Ask Him:

- For the **faith to pray**
- For the **grace to follow**
- For the **strength to trust**

Hebrews 12:2 – Jesus is the **Author and Finisher** of our faith. Let God lead you. Let Him shape your prayers. Let Him *pray through you*—with understanding, with power, with divine purpose. That's when **heavenly fire** falls—every prayer meeting, every time.

2 Peter 1:3–10 – A Call to Spiritual Maturity

You have given me **everything I need** for life and godliness. Through knowing You, I have been called to glory—not shame, to excellence—not mediocrity. I receive the **precious and great promises** You have spoken over my life. Through them, I step into Your divine nature, escaping the corruption and cravings of this fallen world.

And so, Lord, **add to my faith**:

- **Virtue**—Let my life be marked by purity and moral strength.
- **Knowledge**—Grow me in wisdom and in the truth of Your Word.
- **Self-control**—Train my spirit to say no to the flesh and yes to Your will.
- **Steadfastness**—Build unshakable endurance in me through every trial.
- **Godliness**—Shape my character to reflect Your holiness.
- **Brotherly kindness**—Teach me to love the family of God.
- **Love**—Pour into me the selfless love that mirrors Your heart.

May these qualities **grow and multiply** in me, so that my faith is never empty or fruitless. Keep me from spiritual blindness. Let me never forget the cleansing power of Your mercy that washed away my former sins.

Let my life bear the proof. Let my fruit remain. Let me never fall.

II. Worship: 'Hallowed be Thy Name'

Matthew 6:5–15 – Jesus teaches us to begin prayer not with requests, but with *reverence*.

"Hallowed be Thy Name" is a declaration of God's **holiness**, a call to worship, and an invitation to realign our lives around His glory. To hallow His name means to set it apart as sacred, to exalt it above all, and to live in a way that honors Him.

- **Personal Reflection:**

In what areas of my life does God's holiness need to be exalted?

◆ God's Holiness – A Scriptural Foundation

Old Testament Revelation:

- **Exodus 15:11** – "Who is like You, glorious in holiness…?"
- **Leviticus 11:44** – "Be ye holy; for I am holy."
- **Isaiah 6:1–3** – "Holy, holy, holy is the Lord… the whole earth is full of His glory."
- **1 Samuel 2:2** – "There is none holy as the Lord…"

God's holiness is not just a characteristic—it is **His essence**. It is the blazing center of who He is: pure, perfect, and set apart from all creation.

Jesus Reveals the Holiness of God:

- **Luke 1:49** – "Holy is His name."
- **John 17:11** – "Holy Father, keep them through Your name

New Testament Revelation & Command:

- **1 Peter 1:15–16** – "Be ye holy in all manner of conversation…"
- **Hebrews 12:14** – "Without holiness, no man shall see the Lord."
- **Revelation 4:8** – "Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty…"

Heaven never stops declaring it. Holiness is the eternal anthem of heaven—and it should be the heartbeat of our prayers.

◆ How Do We Respond to God's Holiness?

1. **Reverence** – Approach God with awe, not arrogance.
   His name is not casual—it is sacred.
2. **Repentance** – Holiness exposes sin—not to shame us, but to **transform** us. *Conviction is a call back to closeness.*
3. **Reflection** – Holiness isn't legalism; it's **likeness to Jesus**.
   It's not about rules—it's about radiating Christ.
4. **Realignment** – Holiness reshapes our lives.
   It affects how we pray, how we live, and what we love.

End of sample

Thank you for reading the opening of Lord, Teach Me to Pray.

The full edition is being prepared for publication.

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